



Bobby Jones - 00:41

Hey.



Darren Rosenlund - 00:42

Hey. Good morning gents.



Michael Byers-Norton - 00:45

Just you and I so far.



Bobby Jones - 00:46

Darren.



Michael Byers-Norton - 00:46

How you doing today?



Darren Rosenlund - 00:48

Nice, nice. Doing well I'm on the road here this week.



Michael Byers-Norton - 00:54

Any place exotic?



Darren Rosenlund - 00:56

Oh no, just going up to check kind of project and a couple of projects actually they're all kind of in the both in the same vicinity.



Michael Byers-Norton - 01:09

Nice. I'm guessing Utah then. It's a drive, not a flight.



Darren Rosenlund - 01:12

Yep, yep. Just to drive. Drive up the road.



Michael Byers-Norton - 01:17

That's awesome.



Darren Rosenlund - 01:18

How are things going?



Michael Byers-Norton - 01:21

Pretty good to be honest with you. I just need more time and capacity as always but going really good.



Darren Rosenlund - 01:30

So while you're waiting for Michael rear shied like tell me like what's. What are some of the things that you're. You're focused on what do you guys do day to day? Yeah. Really.



Michael Byers-Norton - 01:42

So like there's a bunch we can go into outside of the play that you and I are talking about right now but relative to what we're trying to make happen and so Tucker's on the line here and he's my partner in crime on this network front right now. We've kind of realized the opportunity at hand is more extreme than we've been putting focus on appropriately particularly from a large portfolio acquisition perspective. There's a lot of pressure from a couple of our investors and their off takers to go after those items like just to try to get as many of these sites in control as possible from the bulk exit perspective.



Darren Rosenlund - 02:21

Yeah.



Michael Byers-Norton - 02:21

And then there's the reality of man we should be cherry picking the ones that we like the most, especially from a cluster perspective, you know, sites that are within that strategic distance of each other for max value. So went ahead and got the ball rolling on a bunch of our fronts because I should send you some of the texts I was getting of like dude we gotta go now we have opportunity now there's buyers, now we have investment now like huge amount of pressure from a normal investor salesy type of folk which I'm cynical about. They're very respectful too as well. Sure, sure.



Michael Byers-Norton - 02:51

But so we got the ball re rolling for two of our other carriers or trying to follow up call with that biz dev team this week and we're putting together like a we want you to help us open the doors those accounts so we can start leading the cause directly and B we're going to put together a program so if we do go deeper on the sites we're going to want them to be part of that facility audit program and we want you to be that part of that or the one of the two utility audit program. And yeah we have an off taker in mind on those who can take over sites that have a sale leaseback and so they want to own and manage asset sites. Whereas like the three of us will probably be chasing revenue for densification as well.



Michael Byers-Norton - 03:33

So trying to structure that with one of our friends here out of Colorado that does asset management acquisitions but then also have a group poking around that has modular solutions at their hip right now where we can drop in capacity into the parking lot.



Darren Rosenlund - 03:48

Yeah.



Michael Byers-Norton - 03:49

One group from a lease and one group from our own and operate. So try and one of them that just wants us to get the hell out of the way. So there's like three or four islands in that fire that we're trying to.



Darren Rosenlund - 03:58

There's so many of them. Not overwork. Yeah, yeah.



Michael Byers-Norton - 04:02

Trust and verify is a big term that's been used a lot right now.



Darren Rosenlund - 04:05

So 100%.



Michael Byers-Norton - 04:08

So that's kind of moving. So we got this other two carriers and I need a high level number from you that I can keep using for modeling. So if hits the fan I'm not catching you way off guard. Are you in a position to share screen or view a screen?



Darren Rosenlund - 04:26

Yeah, yeah. I can see I'm on my phone here. So I can.



Michael Byers-Norton - 04:30

I'll try to be a little bit more gentle then. So this is with the. I put this together to kind of highlight to the investment group that I'm working with like hey, we're gonna need some sort of budget because to them \$2 million is not a scary number at all. And so I'm trying to highlight like you don't want to just grab the portfolio and flip completely. Maybe we can but at the same piece my assumption is we'll need to go through there and review every site and we'll need to actually look at everything that's there to make a pitch to help these people pull that trigger. But I don't like there has to be some sort of per site diligent budgets that we're looking for. And so I'm trying to get like a utility terabyte one just to get the tires on it.



Michael Byers-Norton - 05:11

You know, just run it through our normal machine and grind and produce some data room ish type of materials. And Tucker and I are working pretty aggressively to get that smooth. Then you right now I just threw ten grand per site as a target. I have no idea. Right. So that's where I need you to buffer there.



Darren Rosenlund - 05:29

It just ten grand's fine for. For like my time. But I don't know what the travel looks like on each of you know what I mean? So yes.



Michael Byers-Norton - 05:36

And that's where I threw another five grand t down per site.



Darren Rosenlund - 05:40

Yeah.



Michael Byers-Norton - 05:40

Like I just threw a number at the wall and then I'm the biggest thing, the undertone reality of all this. Most the carriers are running into don't have the time to give a about this like that. These are just cost centers on their books.



Darren Rosenlund - 05:54

Sure.



Michael Byers-Norton - 05:54

They're not gonna have budgets to spend. So I'm assuming we're gonna do a fair amount of inside of audits and work as well.



Darren Rosenlund - 06:03

Yeah, no, I, I, I appreciate that. And it's like sick. I think that's like for my time, that's what my retainers are, 10 grand. So that's fine. But I just don't know what travel because you, sometimes you're having to meet with, you know, face to face is how you got to meet with a lot of these utilities, you know, county guys, entitlement people, economic development people. You've got to meet face to face with them as much as possible at least a couple of times. And so yeah, depending on where these projects are, you just got to hop on a plan and go. You know, it's half my, I would say half of my weeks I'm traveling. It's, it's not good sometimes, but it's just part of the thing, part of the gig.



Darren Rosenlund - 06:48

And so you got to just get on site, get boots on the ground, especially in the beginning.



Michael Byers-Norton - 06:57

Okay.



Darren Rosenlund - 06:57

So, so just, yeah, keep that in mind. I don't know. And, and a lot of these projects are non NFL cities. So you've gotta run a car, you've gotta like land somewhere and then drive somewhere, you know, and it's just, it takes an extra day or 2, 100.



Michael Byers-Norton - 07:22

And that's like the bottleneck risk here. But the same piece if all these sites are in one area. Like that's kind of what we're trying to pull out when we do our initial desktop review.



Darren Rosenlund - 07:32

It's like you try to do as much research as you can. That's right, absolutely. And then spend the money. Once you narrow down, you feel good about it. Yeah.



Michael Byers-Norton - 07:43

And in best case scenario, and this is just from my personal experience on it, if I can get the local stakeholder so like the AT&T facility ops manager and make sure he's happy, everything else moves. So and then. All right, so I'm going to add in here and enabled energy. Let's do facility.



Darren Rosenlund - 08:11

Okay.



Michael Byers-Norton - 08:11

And this will be enabled. I got introduced to these guys sometime. They're just a super badass environmental efficiency audit group. They're just. They stay in their niche and they are very effective. Yeah. Sites progressing to do.



Darren Rosenlund - 08:32

They do. So I've got a guy too who I turn to who's worked for all the big. Well, he's worked for three of the big aws, Meta and Google and he does. It's almost like a evaluation for these sites up front. And so it's hard to. Do you guys have somebody like that to turn to.



Michael Byers-Norton - 08:55

I got my super curmudgeony badass old engineer sub nuclear sub guy out of Philadelphia and John Diamond. You'll don't know if you cross his path in the past, but.



Darren Rosenlund - 09:07

Nope, not yet.



Michael Byers-Norton - 09:08

So he's one of the ones who's willing to do it. But he's also very much retirement age. But he's so he's one of the

very few I have. I used to send out one of our electrical engineers down out of Texas, but now he's like pretty high up on leadership at Qualis. So I don't have enough of those people right now. And that's where.



Darren Rosenlund - 09:27

Yeah, I've got a guy who I, I have tapped for all of my projects as I'm going through initial diligence. And he's. He's really good too. So if we ever need something like that.



Michael Byers-Norton - 09:39

Do you have a ballpark number? I'm not planning to put you or him on the spot, but is he like a five, three, a ten grand type of person per se?



Darren Rosenlund - 09:45

I think if he's a. I think he's like a five grand. That's what I've paid him for. And you know, maybe I can talk him down. But that's. He was. I thought that was a pretty good number. So I just paid it and I've been paying it. So with his experience and he'll travel if you need him to.



Michael Byers-Norton - 10:09

That's the dream. And so that's like. That's kind of the dream. Right. So what I'm trying to do, and this is where I'm just highlighting notes on here in yellow for me to clean up as we go through this. But basically we have this one investor. I got them distracted by this portfolio play because they're. Stop me if I've explained all this last week, but one of the members of this new fund that's coming together, he comes from the asset disposition world, particularly in oil and gas or they're used to selling 500 wells at a time like very large transactions, infrastructure wise. So he got excited trying to chase some of these carrier plays that way, but they're. They don't come from telco. They don't understand the brain damage yet.



Michael Byers-Norton - 10:52

So I'm like, I'm trying to separate that noise from the ability for us to stand up a program that's. But Tucker and I just been calling his new Edge co. You know, just a new spv.



Darren Rosenlund - 11:03

Yeah.



Michael Byers-Norton - 11:03

Just actually get control and do this work. And so that's kind of like where we're sitting right now as a dream state. So like just for example, if we.



Darren Rosenlund - 11:13

Were doing that background is very useful. I can see why he's after this a big time.



Michael Byers-Norton - 11:20

And that was just like one of those like, all right, we need to carve out what we want in general here to make sure that if we are being approached by individuals like that, we're in a good spot, ready to go and then. Yeah, exactly. So basically the whole idea right now is work together to snipe sites that we want. And that's where we got to wait for a rare shot to get back for that specific account. But then we should be off and running with that group. We're trying to get our way back in front of Lumen and Verizon, so very large accounts. And Tucker and I are trying to prepare for that.



Darren Rosenlund - 11:59

Oh moment.



Michael Byers-Norton - 12:01

And then I hit up another route to try to get. It's going to take a couple steps, like a few degrees away on that one,

but to try to get us into the AT&T family in the same realm.



Darren Rosenlund - 12:11

And. And also the opportunity is so loud.



Michael Byers-Norton - 12:14

Yeah, yeah. We're talking like they previously were warning us about, you know, like nine to 15,000 sites.



Darren Rosenlund - 12:21

Yeah.



Michael Byers-Norton - 12:21

So it's.



Darren Rosenlund - 12:22

It's like. Yeah, you've gotta go at that point.



Michael Byers-Norton - 12:26

Well, that's where rare shy DRD did the brain damage for us to go from 20 or 2000 down to 20 or down to 200.



Darren Rosenlund - 12:32

200.



Michael Byers-Norton - 12:34

So that's kind of where we started this exercise. But it's. We're kind of chasing this right now as though this is an emerging market that's proper. And I got off one of my land development investor calls this morning and they're reiterating the same thing of the concerns about the big sites slowing down.



Darren Rosenlund - 12:53

That's right.



Michael Byers-Norton - 12:53

Just due to overextension and, you know, capital requirements and political.



Darren Rosenlund - 12:58

So it's like community outrage.



Michael Byers-Norton - 13:01

Thousand percent. So that's where I think this it's.



Darren Rosenlund - 13:04

Turned niche is worth our focus it's yeah, absolutely. 100 Agreeing. And I'm trying to keep it on the download just a bit, but it seems like it's not. I mean everybody's jumping into this everywhere I turn.



Michael Byers-Norton - 13:16

Yeah.



Darren Rosenlund - 13:17

That's where more than half of my conversations are focused on this type of deployment, this type of strategy. And it's just what it is now. Now we have to execute now we have to like you say, get that, land that anchor, you know, opportunity and execute and we'll. Or kill it. It'll be crazy.



Michael Byers-Norton - 13:39

100 It. So I'm planning to hit up yada here in two weeks to really focus on getting some more modular people lined up. I'm putting together like just so we know what cards we have to play at our pocket in general.



Darren Rosenlund - 13:53

Yeah.



Michael Byers-Norton - 13:53

And we have a few external friends who help with that as well. But it's just.



Darren Rosenlund - 13:57

Yeah. The modular stuff is a dime a dozen. You can find all kinds of players that you can. It's just it, you know, you've got to really dig into their equipment and their back order, you know, generators and everything that this, you know, they've got. How fast can they deliver and, and can you sniff out if they're overselling and they tell you 12 months and it's really three years, you know, 100.



Michael Byers-Norton - 14:27

We're dealing with that right now with a couple of these names that are ridiculously big names from putting together modular programs like supply chain and delivery, perspective wise.



Darren Rosenlund - 14:36

Yep.



Michael Byers-Norton - 14:36

But it's the exact same piece. And like we met with a giga energy last week. Like been hyping pretty hard like I like those guys. And at the same piece like they're only 400 or only 200 megawatts into their data center experience, like as owner operators. So it's just one of those. The ball is just getting rolling in this direction. I don't think we're too late. But you're absolutely right like that sanity check on what's real. I'm looking for who's been credentialized, like who's had an Nvidia sign off on their modular setup. And that's. I need three of those in my pocket. Likewise, if you have those in your pocket, keep developing.



Darren Rosenlund - 15:13

Yeah, I have some and I've. And that's. That's where I've been. All of my conversations are centered around is there any transparency, anything you can show me that you can actually deliver when. When we're asking that's so important.



Michael Byers-Norton - 15:27

Yeah.



Darren Rosenlund - 15:29

Amen you got these critical timelines that everybody's on.



Michael Byers-Norton - 15:33

So, so true. So that's where it's.



Darren Rosenlund - 15:38

Well, I love. So now what? What can I do? Is there anything I can do to help? Is there. Sounds like we've got a lot of conversations happening, but just gotta wait. Is there anything I can. You say I can get on the phone with somebody, I can help pitch and talk to them about whatever. Whatever we need to.



Michael Byers-Norton - 15:59

I appreciate that willingness to jump in, but this is where I don't have a clear ask right now. Like, and this is where, you know, Tucker and I need to sit down and start to put together like, those clear asks and make sure we're running properly here. And so it's a. Like, right now I think I'm reactive to see if I can get responses from these other three carriers before the week's out and then kind of just, you know, understand our real roadmap to sites. I've also tried to start hitting up a local or a group of ours that is doing a lot of power land developments and they're running across, you know, one to five megawatt power sites. So I'm trying to figure out a solution with them that's outside this network play.



Michael Byers-Norton - 16:41

So it's just really still trying to put these bones together in a way we can run. But I think where I'm going to panically reach out to you is if we do need to raise funds, like, that's going to be that sanity check of budget to what are we really trying to do? And we're trying to get our heads on our shoulders here before. In the next two weeks, basically to make sure we know what we're asking for. So meeting with those investors for dinner next Thursday. So that's kind of our roadmap right now.



Darren Rosenlund - 17:09

I love it. Sounds good. Yeah. These next two weeks, I'm traveling to different sites. So hit me up anytime, text me, call me. I'm happy to jump on a call and anywhere I can help. Happy to do it.



Michael Byers-Norton - 17:23

Appreciate that. Go from there. So I guess a real quick one. Do you have any experience, either you or your power guy, of like taking a building that's been designed with like 2N distribution of power, so like 2N at the transformer level and then splitting that. So go from like a block redundant to distributed redundant. The utility side?



Darren Rosenlund - 17:48

Yeah.



Michael Byers-Norton - 17:48

You've been exposed to that much.



Darren Rosenlund - 17:50

So. So one of the guys that I'm working for, like working for and helping consult with now, he's part of a Group and they do a lot of that. It sounds very like I'm not in the technical weeds of it, but he's done this for 20 years and it sounds very much in line with what he's doing. And so if you've got something that I would probably have to figure out how to pull him away and say, hey, can you work on the side on something like this and help me? Because he's amazing and he can take any brownfield. You know, that's what he does day in and day out as an engineer. He's just, he'll look at it and you know, 10 minutes later he'll find all the holes, all the reasons why it can't be done. And he's. Yeah, he's smart.



Michael Byers-Norton - 18:39

So you mentioned you have to pull him away from his day job like, or how do we work with. So I have a one off site type of thing. What we would do.



Darren Rosenlund - 18:46

Yeah, I would have to have that conversation with him. He's. He's a guy I absolutely have confidence in. He could help me figure that out. But I'd have to have a conversation with him and say, hey, can you do this on the side? Okay, so.



Michael Byers-Norton - 18:59

So I won't call for that paper yet. My principal, like, there's a site we've been chasing out in Maryland for a while now, but we finally just got control of it with one of my clients. And it's 4 megawatts a day, but we think we can split it into six type of moment.



Darren Rosenlund - 19:14

Yeah.



Michael Byers-Norton - 19:15

So it's just like. But I don't know, I don't think we have the expertise in our family. Do that appropriately. Yeah, it might be something I knock on you for coming off.



Darren Rosenlund - 19:23

He absolutely would know how to do that. So. Okay, that's what they're doing with all their sites.



Michael Byers-Norton - 19:30

And so that guy, he's not the same one doing the site visit though, right?



Darren Rosenlund - 19:34

No, no, he's excellent. He's a different guy.



Michael Byers-Norton - 19:38

Okay, that's fantastic. So I think that's it. And that's the biggest one, two punch right now. And. Okay. Yeah. Just trying to keep her head on our shoulders. Otherwise. Well, we did pick up. Yeah, we're doing enough to get drowned. And that's the fun part. But we picked up a contract like I just countersigned it this morning to basically finish fitting out to legacy telco sites or communications episodes. And they say they have a lot of teams internally that know what they're doing. But that's one where once we get into those weeds a little bit more and figure out where their teams really are, that might be an opportunity for us to just do one off project or two off project as they develop that. So that's kind of interesting. 2 Megawatt and potentially 20 megawatt site for your two different markets.



Michael Byers-Norton - 20:28

I'm trying to think there's anything else cooking right now that's worth hyping you on.



Darren Rosenlund - 20:31

I love it.



Michael Byers-Norton - 20:34

It's probably it. But yeah, like. So I think as I'm just talking out loud now, I'm bullshitting you. The big financial group I'm working a ton with, they're bringing me sites left and right, like overwhelming me. So, so that's a lot of our discussion here in a week is like make sure we're getting paid for this proper type of moment. But I might be needing a package type offering from you where I can just tap you in to do the same type of sanity check on these

guys solutions. One of the groups we met with that I, I don't believe in but gosh, I want to believe in. They know how to go into unregulated markets and kind of build a solution for the power contract like the ESA or ppa. But it gives them the chance to basically play arbitrage on that deal.



Michael Byers-Norton - 21:23

So they're the ones kind of trading on the spot markets to bring enough power in to fulfill that epa. But it lets them potentially collect a penny or so on that ppa.



Darren Rosenlund - 21:33

Sure, yeah.



Michael Byers-Norton - 21:34

Per kilowatt hour which I don't know if that's real or not.



Darren Rosenlund - 21:39

I've seen groups doing that so that's what I'm trying to see could be possible. Yeah.



Michael Byers-Norton - 21:47

Okay.



Darren Rosenlund - 21:48

Yeah.



Michael Byers-Norton - 21:48

So as soon as I learn more there's an opportunity to bring you in as an expert on that discussion.



Darren Rosenlund - 21:53

Yeah, I'm happy to jump in there.



Michael Byers-Norton - 21:57

Okay, so that'll be another one to bring up to the our Chicago based friends. And then last one, what's your experience doing COMED or Nipsco like so Indiana or Illinois power? Like you have any experience navigating those processes?



Darren Rosenlund - 22:13

Working one right now. Yeah, Indiana I'm working on. It's a brand new one and they've got excellent, they've got, they said they have another one so there may be two indiana and it's the very front end. So I've got to get on the phone my calls Thursday I believe with them three ladies. There's three Ladies. And they're. They're all gung ho. They've got these sites talking about their power commitments right now, and it sounds like it's promising, but it's in. It's indiana and they said that there's probably two of them, so.



Michael Byers-Norton - 22:50

Okay.



Darren Rosenlund - 22:50

No. 300. 300 Megawatts.



Michael Byers-Norton - 22:53

So just document everything you can relative to working through that Nipscope process.



Darren Rosenlund - 22:57

Yeah.



Michael Byers-Norton - 22:58

So that way you have an idea of those timelines and those costs and.



Darren Rosenlund - 23:01

Yep.



Michael Byers-Norton - 23:02

Because there might be a large number of sites coming in that you know what to filter through first. But, yeah, that's. Those two markets I am not personally comfortable in. So.



Darren Rosenlund - 23:11

Yeah, I've. I'm. This is my first one there, so. And there's two of them, so I'll learn a lot going through this.



Michael Byers-Norton - 23:18

Excellent. That's awesome. Small roll to the moment.



Darren Rosenlund - 23:21

Yeah.



Michael Byers-Norton - 23:22

Love it.



Darren Rosenlund - 23:23

Cool.



Michael Byers-Norton - 23:24

But I think that's all I got cooking at the moment. Bobby, you just jumped on. I'm sorry to throw this back on you. Is there anything you want touch on?



Bobby Jones - 23:34

Yep. Sorry, guys. Really apologize being so late. I just got stuck on a call over. But no, just chaos. But no, I don't want to bogart Yalls call every. Everything going good?



Darren Rosenlund - 23:45

All good. Yeah. Great to hear from you, man. Lots of stuff, man. It's like you gotta. You gotta just sit still for a second. It's. It's so hard. My head is spinning with all the different projects that are coming now at me, and it's just. You have to pick your spots. How much is. How much is real? So.



Bobby Jones - 24:06

Yeah, yeah, no, I. Yeah, that's. That's why I wouldn't have left y' all hanging if the call was on. I think it actually could be good for. I mean, just bringing more sites into the. Into the fold and kind of a better machine from a real developer who. Who knows how to. To suss things out, who's not looking for a lot. It's somebody we've worked with for a while, so, you know, more to come. But. But they've got. You know, it's just another layer we have or another source of. Of fresh. Fresh supply, but from somebody that's actually pretty good at the power development side. So, yeah, you can kind of count on them.



Darren Rosenlund - 24:42

Fantastic. I like those people.



Bobby Jones - 24:44

Yeah, man. Yeah, we. I don't know. Like, I don't know if Mike told you were on a call earlier. I feel like, you know, this week is the ultimate check back. We all need to sober up all this money and time and everything. You know, there's all these things that we haven't thought enough about, especially from the finance side of just, they're now waking up to all the due diligence they didn't do a very good job of. And I think that's all good for people that are going to try to be adults in the room and, you know, like, people that have been in the development world for a while and are used to some headwinds, you know, whether or not it's community or, you know, governmental or whatever. And. And so I think it'll be. I don't see there be any way.



Bobby Jones - 25:25

I see a lot of the wildcatters who say they're bringing supply. A lot of that'll turn out. We already knew. Always knew it would be like kind of vapor. Vapor megawatts. But I think that all is gonna, you know, make it just a tighter market. The demand doesn't seem like it's really. I don't believe any of this stuff. That demand's all of a sudden gonna fall in half.



Darren Rosenlund - 25:48

No, this is. We're playing in the right spot again. I feel like it's just gonna get a little bit more crowded, a little bit more red ocean here. So it's this. This is the right. Right place to be.



Bobby Jones - 25:59

Yeah. It's a good way to put it. Oh, yeah.



Darren Rosenlund - 26:03

So, Yeah, let's be in touch. Like, let me know how things roll this week. And like I said, I'm happy to jump on a text or phone call anytime, so.



Bobby Jones - 26:16

Sounds good.



Michael Byers-Norton - 26:17

Travels, man.



Darren Rosenlund - 26:18

All right, thanks. Appreciate it.



Bobby Jones - 26:21

Talk soon.



Darren Rosenlund - 26:22

See you guys. Bye. Bye.